PAPPARDELLE WITH PORCINI AND VEAL BOLOGNESE

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
4-6	**4 h plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Egg dough
56 g	Dried porcini mushrooms
1.4 kg	Room-temperature water
200 g	Fennel bulb
236 g	Onion
10 g	Garlic
28 g	Olive oil, for the veal
112 g	Olive oil, for the soffritto
896 g	Ground veal
220 g	Dry white wine
122 g	Juice from canned San Marzano tomatoes
1	Fresh bay leaf
2 sprigs	Thyme
2 sprigs	Rosemary
1 sprig	Sage
2 g	Coriander seed
9 g	Black peppercorns
30 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
20 g	Parsley, finely chopped
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
quantity not given	Whole nutmeg
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

1. For the ragù, cover the porcini with cool water in a bowl and soak them 5 minutes, sloshing them around with your hand a few times to shift the dirt. Drain, return them to the bowl, pour the 1.4 kg of room-temperature water over and leave them 30 minutes to 1 hour to soften.
2. Once they are fully hydrated, drain them and keep the soaking liquid, which should come to about 948 g. Chop the mushrooms finely. Keep mushrooms and liquid separate.
3. While the porcini soak, fit the small die to a meat grinder. Core the fennel and strip off its fronds and stems. Cut the fennel and onion into ½- to 1-inch pieces. Pass the garlic, onion and fennel through the grinder, then gather the ground mixture in cheesecloth and wring the liquid out of it. That is the soffritto.
4. Warm the 28 g of oil over medium-high heat in a heavy Dutch oven or sauce pot. Add the veal and cook 5 to 7 minutes, crumbling it into small even pieces with a wooden spoon, to just cooked through. Lift it out with a slotted spoon into a bowl.
5. Turn the heat to low. Add the remaining 112 g of oil, the soffritto and the chopped porcini. Cook 3 to 5 minutes, stirring often, until softened but still pale.
6. Pour in the wine and cook about 5 minutes, until it has nearly all gone.
7. Put the veal back in, then pour in the porcini liquid you reserved along with the San Marzano juice.
8. Tie the peppercorns, coriander seed, bay leaf, sage, rosemary and thyme into a cheesecloth sachet and drop it in.
9. Cook on low 2 to 3 hours. The flavors should have melded and the meat should be completely soft.
10. Off the heat, salt to taste. Measure 606 g of ragù out for this dish. The rest keeps in an airtight container, 5 days refrigerated or a month frozen.
11. Cut 624 g of pappardelle from the egg dough.
12. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil over high heat.
13. Set a large saute pan over medium-low heat and add the measured ragù.
14. Cook the pappardelle 1 to 2 minutes. The ribbons want to be tender, not soft.
15. Lift the pasta over with tongs or a pasta basket, raise the heat to medium and add the butter and one ladle of pasta water, 55 g. Work pasta and sauce together for about a minute, alternating between tossing and folding with a wooden spoon. A splash more pasta water loosens it if it tightens. Fold the parsley through. The ragù should coat

the ribbons without clumping on them.

16. Divide into bowls and finish with the parmigiano, grated nutmeg and pepper to taste.

NOTES

The porcini soaking water is an ingredient. About 948 g of it goes into the ragù and carries most of the mushroom flavor.
The mushrooms get soaked twice. The first 5 minutes in cool water is a wash for grit, the long soak is what softens them.
Veal is milder and softer than beef or pork, which is the point. There is no milk and no tomato paste either, just a splash of tomato juice, so the porcini and the veal are not buried under fat or sweetness.
Wringing the ground soffritto dry in cheesecloth stops the ragù stewing in vegetable water.
606 g of ragù dresses this pasta. The batch makes considerably more than that.

SHAPE

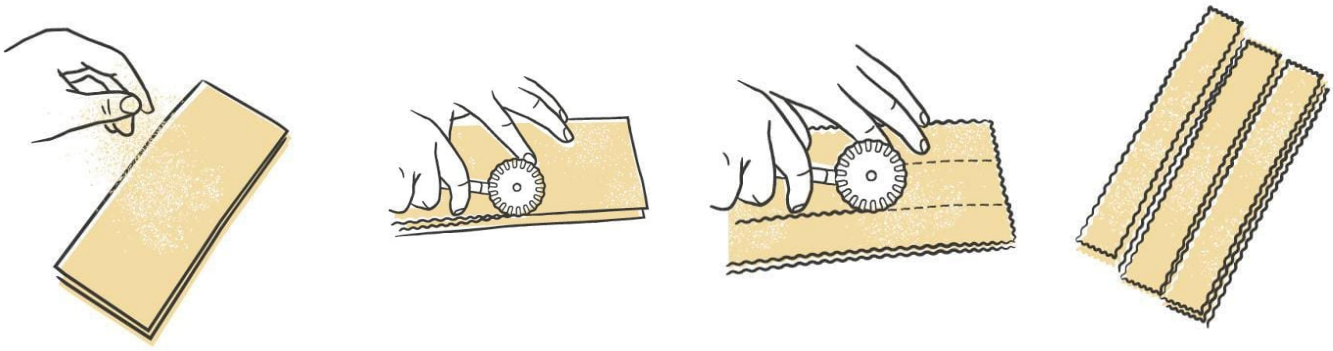
Pappardelle

Region: Found throughout Italy, densest in Tuscany / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature

METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 9-inch lengths and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup.
4. Dust each sheet lightly with 00 flour and stack them neatly two or three high. Run a fluted pastry cutter around every edge of the stack so all four sides come out ruffled.
5. Starting at the long edge of the stack, cut 1 1/4-inch strips working inward. A ruler or straightedge keeps the lines honest until the fluted cutter feels familiar.
6. Pull the strips apart, dust each one lightly with 00 flour, then restack them 10 to 12 pieces high and set the stacks on the pan.
7. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.
8. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
9. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3 4

NOTES

Cut width is 1 1/4 inches, with a fluted pastry cutter. All four edges of the stack get ruffled before the strips are cut.
Sheets go 9 inches long, stacked two or three high to cut. The finished strips get restacked 10 to 12 high on the pan.
Robbins makes a second version from her chickpea dough alongside the egg-dough one.
Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours.
Pairs with any ragu that suits, historically game ragu such as rabbit or hare, and also with chickpeas and rosemary.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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